

Benny Conn

Backend Software Engineer

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Musician-turned-engineer with 5+ years building production backend systems. Started as a jazz trombonist, taught myself to code, and have since shipped products used by tens of thousands of people.

Experience

CTO & Founding Engineer Trackyard | New York, NY | *January 2024 - March 2026*

- Architected and launched an **AI-powered music search** platform indexing 50K+ tracks across a vector search and embedding pipeline, becoming the company's core product and primary revenue driver.
- Built automated media pipelines that **reduced catalog processing time by 67%**, scaling content operations without adding headcount.
- Shipped an AI-driven short-form video generation tool that **grew social media engagement 150%** within 30 days of launch.

Founder & CTO Gig App | New York, NY | *May 2024 - December 2025 (side project)*

- Built a state-persisted payout pipeline that routes money between venues, musicians & vendors, **cutting failed transactions 90%**.
- Slashed **cold-start load time 60%** by layering Redis + on-device caching for API, inter-service and DB calls.
- Automated video and voice-over marketing asset generation using OpenAI and ffmpeg, producing weekly promo content for 100+ gigs.

Backend Software Engineer II Gallery | Los Angeles, CA | *September 2021 - December 2023*

- Owned end-to-end design and delivery of a media processing pipeline **handling 3M+ uploads**, improving accuracy 75% and cutting infrastructure costs 10%.
- Architected automated data sync pipelines across multiple third-party services, **cutting new user onboarding time by 90%** and directly unblocking the growth team.
- Built a real-time notification system delivering thousands of weekly alerts to **15K+ active users**, coordinating across product, design, and engineering to ship on time.
- Built a stateful real-time event processing pipeline with guaranteed ordering across concurrent workers, state resumption on restart, and automatic gap detection to backfill missed historical data.

Projects

Solo Trace | Go, Python, CLAP, CLIP, Demucs, Basic Pitch, Cloudflare

- Built a multi-model ML pipeline that automatically detects, extracts, and transcribes my jazz solos from nightly live recordings at Smalls Jazz Club in NYC.
- Pipeline runs on a self-hosted Mac Mini via Cloudflare Tunnel, using audio similarity search, computer vision, source separation, and MIDI transcription to isolate and analyze my playing.

Education

Manhattan School of Music – Jazz Performance, 2020-2021 (*left to pursue software engineering*)

Skills

Programming: Golang, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Javascript, Python, C++

Infrastructure: AWS, GCP, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Docker, gRPC, WebSockets

Frameworks: Gin, GraphQL, Next.js/React, Expo/React Native, Spring Boot

Tools: Git, Sentry, OpenAI, Claude, Gemini